

A R C H I T E C T U R E O F G R A C E

T H E I N T E R I O R
G R A D E S 6 – 8

Anchor Chart

Production Pack

28 charts · 4 units · one classroom year

P R O D U C T I O N N O T E S

Print on A3 or A2 · Draw on chart paper · Laminate for repeated use

School of Life Foundation
James Anthony Ramsden, Founder

P I L O T V E R S I O N 2 0 2 6 – 2 0 2 7

Confidential — For District Review Only

CONTENTS

All Twenty-Eight Charts

UNIT	LESSON	CHART	STATUS
Unit 1	L1	Mask vs. Mirror	
	L2	Shame vs. Guilt	
	L3	The Digital Backpack	
	L4	Signal vs. Noise	
	L5	Label vs. Integrity	
	L6	The Choice-Agency Map	
	L7	Unit 1 Wrap-Up — All charts displayed	
Unit 2	L1	The Internal Critic	
	L2	Highlight Reel vs. Bloopers Reel	
	L3	The Perfectionism Spectrum	
	L4	Accountability vs. Self-Punishment	
	L5	The Friend Test	
	L6	Crisis Resources	HIGHEST RISK
	L7	Unit 2 Wrap-Up — All charts displayed	
Unit 3	L1	Impact vs. Intent	
	L2	Three Sides of Every Story	
	L3	Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation	HIGH RISK
	L4	Flame vs. Pause	PERMANENT
	L5	Rumour & Narrative Hijack — Reference U3L1, U3L4	
	L6	The Agency of Release	HIGHEST RISK
	L7	Limits	PERMANENT
Unit 4	L1	What Is Grace?	PERMANENT
	L2	What Is Mercy?	
	L3	The Pause — Charitable Interpretation	
	L4	Micro-Moment Menu	
	L5	Difficult vs. Unsafe	
	L6	Grace Gap	
	L7	Community Charter	PERMANENT

UNIT 1 • LESSON 1
Identity & The Weight of Perception

Mask vs. Mirror

Who am I when I'm performing — and who am I when I'm not?

THE MASK

What I show

Perform. What I emphasize for the audience in front of me.

Edit. What I leave out, soften, or rewrite for safety.

Hide. What I keep behind the curtain so it can't be used.

THE MIRROR

What is true

Real opinions. What I actually think when no one is watching.

Actual struggles. What I'm carrying that the Mask never shows.

Real values. What I would protect even if no one applauded.

"The gap between these two is where the cost lives."

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Where is the gap between your two sides biggest — and what does that gap cost you?

POST

Before class. Day 1 of the year.

KEEP

All year. Grades 7–8: add the gap quote below the columns.

UNIT 1 • LESSON 2

Identity & The Weight of Perception

Shame vs. Guilt

The most important distinction of Unit 1.

SHAME	GUILT
About who I am.	About what I did.
<i>“I am bad.”</i>	<i>“I made a bad choice.”</i>
Identity-level · Global	Behaviour-level · Specific
Points toward HIDING	Points toward REPAIR
<i>“Why even try? I’m hopeless.”</i>	<i>“Fix it. Do better. Try again.”</i>
Almost never produces growth.	Produces repair and growth.

“When you hear the inner critic, ask: is this attacking my behaviour, or my identity?”

POST

Before class. Color-code the two columns.

KEEP

All unit. Revisit in Unit 2.

UNIT 1 • LESSON 3
Identity & The Weight of Perception

The Digital Backpack

Everything you post, share, react to, and comment on goes in here — and mostly stays.

WHAT GOES IN

Posts • Comments • Likes • Shares • Screenshots • Direct Messages

MOSTLY
Permanent

Even deleted content can be screenshot, cached, or remembered.

POTENTIALLY
Public

Multiple audiences may see what you post for one.

CARRIES
Longer

Things stay longer than you ever intended.

“Once it’s in, it stays.”

POST

Before class.

KEEP

Unit 1.

UNIT 1 • LESSON 4
Identity & The Weight of Perception

Signal vs. Noise

The volume of integrity — and the noise that drowns it out.

SIGNAL

Integrity

The consistent, quiet voice of your values.

Always present. Doesn't change with the room.

Easy to lose track of when the room gets loud.

NOISE

Peer pressure

Loud, surrounding, hard to hear past.

Changes from room to room, group to group.

Wants you to forget the signal exists.

THREE MECHANISMS OF PEER PRESSURE

1

SOCIAL PROOF

Everyone is doing it — so it must be right.

2

FEAR OF EXCLUSION

If I don't go along, I lose my seat at the table.

3

IDENTITY MERGER

My group's opinion is my opinion.

“The signal never goes away. The challenge is hearing it past the noise.”

POST

Before class.

KEEP

All of Unit 1.

UNIT 1 • LESSON 5
Identity & The Weight of Perception

Label vs. Integrity

Author of your story.

LABEL

From the outside

Assigned by other people.

Based on social dynamics, reputation, rumour.

Tells you what others see.

Written by someone else's story.

INTEGRITY STATEMENT

From the inside

Claimed by you.

Based on your values, your choices, your authorship.

Tells you who you actually are.

Written by you.

THE FOUR PROMPTS

I am ____ • I value ____ • I choose ____ • The story I am telling
is ____

“Who gets to write your story?”

POST

Before class.

KEEP

Through U1L7.

UNIT 1 • LESSON 6
Identity & The Weight of Perception

The Choice-Agency Map

Three rings. One question: where does your response live?

OUTER RING

Outside my control

What others say. Weather.
Past events. Other
people's choices and
feelings.

MIDDLE RING

I can influence

Conversations I enter.
Effort I put in. How I show
up. What I model for
others.

INNER CIRCLE

I fully choose

My response. My words.
My next step. The story I
tell myself about what just
happened.

“My response always lives in the inner circle.”

*“Between what happens to us and how we respond,
there is always a space. In that space is our power to
choose.”*

— Viktor Frankl (adapted)

POST

Before class. Pre-populate the outer ring with 3–4
examples.

KEEP

Unit 1. Reference again in Unit 4.

UNIT 1 • LESSON 7
Unit 1 Wrap-Up & Bridge to Unit 2

All Unit 1 Charts

Six concepts, one foundation — displayed simultaneously.

THE SIX CHARTS OF UNIT 1

LESSON 1

Mask vs. Mirror

Identity & the cost of performance.

LESSON 2

Shame vs. Guilt

The most important distinction.

LESSON 3

The Digital Backpack

Once it's in, it stays.

LESSON 4

Signal vs. Noise

The volume of integrity.

LESSON 5

Label vs. Integrity

Author of your story.

LESSON 6

Choice-Agency Map

Three rings. One question.

“Look at what this class built.”

FACILITATION

Allow sixty seconds of silent scanning. Then ask: what is the most important thing Unit 1 taught you about yourself?

POST

All six charts simultaneously, before class.

KEEP

Display for U1L7 only.

UNIT 2 • LESSON 1

Self-Compassion & The Internal Critic

The Internal Critic

Three tactics — plus the compassionate witness.

THE INTERNAL CRITIC	COMPASSIONATE WITNESS
CATASTROPHISING “Everything is ruined.”	HONEST + SPECIFIC “This moment was hard. It will pass.”
GLOBALISING “I ALWAYS fail. I NEVER get it right.”	FAIR + KIND “Sometimes I struggle with this. And I also ____.”
PERSONALISING “Everything that went wrong is my fault.”	NOT A CHEERLEADER “What is my actual part — and what isn’t?”

“The compassionate witness is honest, fair, and kind — without punishment.”

P O S T Before class. Add Compassionate Witness column in Step 3.	K E E P All of Unit 2 and beyond.
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UNIT 2 • LESSON 2
Self-Compassion & The Internal Critic

Highlight Reel vs. Bloopers Reel

You are comparing your bloopers reel to someone else's highlight reel. That comparison is structurally rigged.

HIGHLIGHT REEL

What others post

Curated. Filtered. Best-of.

What we see of others online.

The edited version.

A trailer, not the film.

BLOOPER REEL

What you live

Your full, unedited experience.

The hard moments, the doubts, the failures.

The real version.

Everything the trailer left out.

THE OWN-YARDSTICK

“Compared to me ____ time ago, I have ____.”

The only honest comparison is to your earlier self.

POST

Before class.

KEEP

Unit 2.

UNIT 2 • LESSON 3
Self-Compassion & The Internal Critic

The Perfectionism Spectrum

It is not about high standards. It is about terror masquerading as ambition.

PERFECTIONISM

Failure = I am worthless

Terror masquerading as ambition.

Not starting feels safer than failing.

HEALTHY STRIVING

Failure = data I can learn from

High standards without self-destruction.

Effort matters more than outcome.

← where on this spectrum am I, today, in this subject? →

“Why does perfectionism look like laziness? Because not starting is safer than doing it poorly.”

DISCUSSION PROMPT

What is the fear underneath the left side?

POST

Before class.

KEEP

Unit 2.

UNIT 2 • LESSON 4

Self-Compassion & The Internal Critic

Accountability vs. Self-Punishment

Feeling bad is not the same as taking responsibility. Action is.

ACCOUNTABILITY	SELF-PUNISHMENT
<i>"I made a choice that didn't fit who I want to be."</i>	<i>"I am bad. I will suffer."</i>
Forward motion — produces repair.	Focuses on self — produces nothing.
Guilt in action.	Shame in action.

THE FOUR-STEP ACCOUNTABILITY STRUCTURE

1	HONEST ACKNOWLEDGMENT	Name the choice and its impact — exactly.
2	GENUINE REPAIR	What can I actually do? Do it.
3	COMMITMENT	A different choice next time — specific.
4	MOVE ON	Suffering is not on this list. The four steps are the whole structure.

POST

Before class. Add four-step structure in Step 2.

KEEP

Unit 2. Reference in Unit 3.

UNIT 2 • LESSON 5
Self-Compassion & The Internal Critic

The Friend Test

The skill you already have is empathy toward friends. We are redirecting it toward yourself.

TO MY BEST FRIEND

What I would say

Kind. Fair. Honest.

Without punishment.

Holds them to standards while still seeing them whole.

TO MYSELF

What I actually say

Often harsh.

Sometimes cruel.

Things I would never say to a friend in the same situation.

“Would you say that to your best friend in the same situation?”

DISCUSSION PROMPT

What is the gap between these two voices — and what does that gap tell you?

POST

Before class.

KEEP

Unit 2 and Unit 3.

UNIT 2 • LESSON 6 • **HIGHEST RISK**

Self-Compassion & The Internal Critic

Crisis Resources

Post visibly before students arrive — keep posted for the rest of the year.

CRISIS RESOURCES

988 SUICIDE & CRISIS LIFELINE

Call or text 988

CRISIS TEXT LINE

Text **HOME** to **741741**

YOUR SCHOOL COUNSELOR

Name: _____

Contact: _____

*No new anchor chart for this lesson. The visual environment is calm and minimal.
Crisis resources are the only new posting.*

POST

Before U2L6. Counselor co-facilitation required.

KEEP

Permanent — rest of the year.

UNIT 2 • LESSON 7
Unit 2 Reflection & Bridge to Unit 3

All Unit 2 Charts

Six charts. One unit. Return U2L1 journals before this lesson.

THE SIX CHARTS OF UNIT 2

LESSON 1

Internal Critic

Three tactics — plus the witness.

LESSON 2

Highlight vs. Blooper

The comparison is structurally rigged.

LESSON 3

Perfectionism Spectrum

Terror masquerading as ambition.

LESSON 4

Accountability vs. Self-Punishment

Action, not suffering.

LESSON 5

The Friend Test

Redirect the empathy you already have.

LESSON 6

Crisis Resources

Permanently posted.

“Look at what this unit asked of you. You did that work.”

POST

All Unit 2 charts simultaneously.

KEEP

Display for U2L7.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 1
Empathy & Forgiving Others

Impact vs. Intent

Both are real. Only one determines what repair addresses.

INTENT

What was meant

What was in the mind of the person who acted.

Matters for understanding.

Helps us know what kind of conversation this is.

IMPACT

What was felt

What was experienced by the person who was affected.

Determines what repair addresses.

Doesn't require permission to be real.

“If I accidentally step on your foot, I didn’t intend to hurt you. But your foot hurts. My responsibility is for that impact — even when my intent was not harmful.”

POST

Before class.

KEEP

All of Unit 3.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 2
Empathy & Forgiving Others

Three Sides of Every Story

The third side is the hardest — and the most important.

SIDE 1

Your side

What you experienced.

What you felt.

What you needed.

SIDE 2

Their side

What they experienced.

What they felt.

What they needed.

SIDE 3 ★

Compassionate observer

What someone who cares about both people would see — that neither can see from where they stand.

“Seeing someone’s perspective is not agreeing with what they did.”

P O S T

Before class.

K E E P

Through U3L3.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 3 • HIGH RISK

Empathy & Forgiving Others

Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation

The most important conceptual distinction of Unit 3.

FORGIVENESS	RECONCILIATION
Internal psychological process.	Restoration of a relationship.
Choosing to release resentment.	A separate, external decision.
For your own sake — not theirs.	Requires both people’s readiness.
Requires nothing from the other person.	Requires demonstrated behavioral change.
A gift you give yourself.	Earned — never obligatory.
Can happen alone, in your own heart.	Requires both people.

BOUNDARY

You can forgive someone and still choose never to be in a relationship with them again. This curriculum never requires forgiveness in situations involving ongoing harm.

POST

Before class. Color-code the two columns.

KEEP

All of Unit 3.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 4 • PERMANENT

Empathy & Forgiving Others

Flame vs. Pause

React vs. respond. The echo dies when no one feeds it.

REACT

Flame

Feeding the fire.

Fast. Emotion-driven.

Makes it worse — even when it feels right.

RESPOND

Pause

Ask: what do I actually want to happen here?

Slow enough to choose.

Minimum effective action.

THE PAUSE — FOUR STEPS

- | | | |
|----------|-----------------|--|
| 1 | STOP | Before sending, posting, or responding. |
| 2 | ASK | What do I actually want to happen here? |
| 3 | CONSIDER | What will this action cause — in an hour, in a week? |
| 4 | CHOOSE | Minimum effective response — or disengage entirely. |

POST

Day 1 of U3L4. Permanent from this point forward.

KEEP

Permanent — rest of the year.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 5
Empathy & Forgiving Others

Rumour & Narrative Hijack

No new permanent chart. Two lines on the board. Reference existing charts.

TWO LINES — ON THE BOARD ONLY

“A rumour is a story told about you by people who are not primarily concerned with whether it is true.”

“The rumour is not you. It is a story someone else is telling.”

Reference: U3L1 Impact vs. Intent • U3L4 Flame vs. Pause (permanent)

*Lesson 5 is the most private lesson of Unit 3. Keep the visual environment quiet.
Two lines on the board is sufficient.*

P O S T

Two lines on board only. No new chart.

K E E P

Reference U3L1 and U3L4.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 6 • **HIGHEST RISK**

Empathy & Forgiving Others

The Agency of Release

Counselor physically in the room. Crisis resources visible. Letter templates face-down at seats.

CRISIS RESOURCES

988 SUICIDE & CRISIS LIFELINE

Call or text 988

CRISIS TEXT LINE

Text **HOME** to **741741**

YOUR SCHOOL COUNSELOR

Name: _____

Contact: _____

No new anchor chart for this lesson. Room is calm and minimal. Letter templates placed face-down at seats before students arrive. Counselor physically present before first student enters.

POST

Crisis resources confirmed visible before U3L6.

KEEP

Permanent — rest of year.

UNIT 3 • LESSON 7 • PERMANENT

Limits from Self-Respect & Bridge to Unit 4

Limits

Setting limits is an act of self-respect — not retaliation.

THE FORMULA

“When you ____, I _____. Going forward, I need _____.”

LIMIT	THREAT
Information about what I need to be okay.	A demand the other person suffer.
A statement about what I will do.	Punishment disguised as a limit.
From a place of self-respect.	From a place of retaliation.
Focused on what I can control.	Focused on what I want done to them.

“A limit is not a punishment. It is not an ultimatum. It is a statement about what YOU will do — which you can actually control.”

POST

Day 1 of U3L7. Permanent from this point.

KEEP

Permanent — rest of the year.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 1 • PERMANENT

Grace & Generosity

What Is Grace?

Grace is not sentimentality. It is chosen strength.

GRACE

*The deliberate choice to extend something generous —
patience, inclusion, the benefit of the doubt — to
someone who has not necessarily earned it.*

THREE REGISTERS OF DIFFICULTY

1	GRACE THAT IS EASY	Toward someone you like, or who has been kind to you.
2	GRACE THAT COSTS SOMETHING	Toward someone neutral or unfamiliar.
3	GRACE THAT IS HARD	Toward someone who has not been kind to you.

POST

Before class. Permanently prominent through U4L7.

KEEP

Permanent — through year-end.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 2
Grace & Generosity

What Is Mercy?

The choice to restrain power — withholding a response that would be justified.

M E R C Y

*Restraining power you could legitimately use —
because something more important than being right is
at stake: the person's capacity to grow.*

M E R C Y

Choosing kindness

Choosing kindness when harshness would be justified.

Holds the relationship and the room.

Costs something of the person who extends it.

J U S T I C E

Matching consequence

Consequences that match the harm caused.

Holds the standard and the truth.

Necessary, not optional, in many cases.

“This tension is real. This lesson does not resolve it. It asks you to sit with it.”

P O S T

Before class.

K E E P

Unit 4.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 3

Grace & Generosity

The Pause

Add Step 0 — charitable interpretation — to the existing Flame vs. Pause chart from U3L4.

ADD TO THE EXISTING FLAME vs. PAUSE CHART

0

CHARITABLE INTERPRETATION

Before you do anything — choose the most generous available explanation. Until you have evidence that it is wrong.

↓ *Steps 1–4 continue as drawn on the existing chart* ↓

“We automatically give charitable interpretation to people we like. That’s where the real practice begins.”

POST

Add Step 0 directly to the existing U3L4 Flame vs. Pause chart.

KEEP

Already permanent.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 4

Grace & Generosity

Micro-Moment Menu

Specific grace acts — choose three for the Grace Challenge.

- ✓ Say the NAME of the person you sit next to when you greet them.
- ✓ Make EYE CONTACT and nod when someone is speaking.
- ✓ Let someone go FIRST when you could have gone first.
- ✓ Remember something someone told you — and bring it back to them.
- ✓ Acknowledge someone's contribution BEFORE adding your own.
- ✓ Notice when someone is LEFT OUT and move toward them.
- ✓ Ask one FOLLOW-UP QUESTION after someone shares something.
- ✓ Sit next to someone who is sitting alone.

““Being nicer” is not a micro-moment. Specificity is the key requirement.”

THREE TESTS

Can I do this in 30 seconds? • Does it cost me something? • Can I observe whether I did it?

POST

Before class.

KEEP

Unit 4.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 5

Grace & Generosity

Difficult vs. Unsafe

This distinction changes everything about what the right response is.

EASY

Welcome the person

Someone you like, or who has been kind to you. Grace is automatic.

DIFFICULT

Practice grace

Irritating. Challenging. Hard to be around. Grace is appropriate and possible.

UNSAFE

Protect yourself

Active harm. Ongoing danger. Safety — not grace — is the priority.

“Grace is not required toward unsafe people. Ever.”

Grace toward difficult people is one of the most important — and most misunderstood — lessons of the year.

P O S T

Before class.

K E E P

Unit 4.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 6

Grace & Generosity

Grace Gap

What to look for. Reference during the observation phase of the final project.

A GRACE GAP

Where the absence of grace creates a noticeably harder experience for someone.

OBSERVE

People

Who is consistently left out? Who is not receiving charitable interpretation?

OBSERVE

Patterns

Where is impatience the default? What goes consistently unacknowledged?

OBSERVE

Moments

Where could one person's inclusion change another's experience?

GOOD AUDIT CRITERIA

Specific • Observable • Actionable • Empathic

POST

Post alongside the What Is Grace? chart during the observation phase.

KEEP

Through U4L7.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • PERMANENT

Year-End Celebration

Community Charter

Co-created and signed by this class — displayed permanently.

FACILITATOR NOTE

This chart is created by students during the lesson. Do not pre-write it. The co-creation process is the lesson.

THE CHARTER INCLUDES

- | | | |
|----------|----------------------------------|---|
| 1 | COMMITMENT SENTENCES | One per student — generated and chosen by them. |
| 2 | EVERY STUDENT'S SIGNATURE | All names. None excluded. |
| 3 | THE DATE | The day this room agreed to this. |

After the lesson: display permanently in the classroom • photograph for the district adoption file.

POST

Created during U4L7. Displayed after signing.

KEEP

Permanent — rest of year.